



Figure 7: Notepad ++ - a text editor



Figure 8: XAMPP - the most popular PHP development environment

syntax highlighting and code folding for more than 50 programming, scripting and markup languages. Notepad++ has large community support and plugins. It also supports Macro recording and playback, Bookmark and PCRE (Perl Compatible Regular Expression) Search/Replace.

XAMPP

XAMPP is an open source, cross-platform tool, which is a favourite among Web developers. The full form of XAMPP is X-Cross platform, Apache, MariaDB, PHP and Perl. Earlier, it used MySQL instead of MariaDB. XAMPP is a complete package of these libraries, so developers don't need to worry about installing and configuring PHP, MariaDB and Apache. It's the simplest way to set up a local Web server.

Firebug

Firebug is one of the most popular tools used by Web developers. It's an extension of Mozilla Firefox that facilitates editing, debugging and monitoring CSS, HTML and JavaScript on a live Web page. Firebug was developed by Joe Hewitt in 2006.

Its key features are:

- Inspects and edits HTML
- Tweaks CSS to perfection
- Visualises CSS metrics
- Monitors network activity
- Debugs and profiles JavaScript
- Quickly finds errors
- Explores the DOM



Figure 9: Firebug - a tool for debugging, and monitoring your Web page



Figure 10: Ember.js - a framework for creating ambitious Web apps

- Executes JavaScript on-the-fly
- Has logging for JavaScript
- Manages cookies

Ember.js

Ember.js is an open source JavaScript framework. Developed by Yehuda Katz and released in December 2011, Ember.js is based on the model-view-controller pattern. It's one of the favourite JavaScript frameworks for single-page Web applications.

I have listed what I rank as the top 10 open source tools here. But there are many more tools that are also popular in these categories like WampServer, phpMyAdmin, Filezilla, JEdit, YSlow, etc. Everyone has their own preferences. Sometimes we love some tools because we are used to them. Try these tools out if you still haven't. **END** 

References

- [1] <http://scottje.net/2015/07/28/a-complete-list-of-web-development-tools/>
- [2] <http://www.infoworld.com/article/2984437/open-source-tools/bossies-2015-the-best-of-open-source-software-awards.html>

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